



Figure 17: Windows XP guest running on Qemu (openSUSE 12.1)

Advantages

By no means does this cryptic command line syntax come closer to the ease of use provided by VirtualBox and VMware Workstation. What are the benefits of Qemu/KVM then, you ask? Well, there's one factor which really adds stars to Qemu/KVM – processing performance.

Even under heavy workloads, Qemu/KVM is known to degrade the processing performance of the virtual machine by no more than 7 per cent. This is the one thing which sets this virtualization combo (Qemu and KVM are two different packages working together) from the rest. In addition, you can actually make a Qemu virtual machine run in the background. This makes it so very easy to be used for remote virtual machines. Performance is perhaps the only benefit you have here. Use Qemu/KVM if you're going to use the virtual machine for performance-intensive tasks.

Disadvantages

Now that you've read and probably used VirtualBox and VMware Workstation, Qemu/KVM have a lot of disadvantages compared to them. The duo would give you poor (really poor) graphics performance. Unless you use the